Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-11-15

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Amos 7:1-9

1 Thus the Lord God showed me: Behold, He formed locust swarms at the beginning of the late crop; indeed it was the late crop after the king's mowings.

2 And so it was, when they had finished eating the grass of the land, that I said: "O Lord God, forgive, I pray! Oh, that Jacob may stand, For he is small!"

3 So the Lord relented concerning this. "It shall not be," said the Lord.

4 Thus the Lord God showed me: Behold, the Lord God called for conflict by fire, and it consumed the great deep and devoured the territory.

5 Then I said: "O Lord God, cease, I pray! Oh, that Jacob may stand, For he is small!"

6 So the Lord relented concerning this. "This also shall not be," said the Lord God.

7 Thus He showed me: Behold, the Lord stood on a wall made with a plumb line, with a plumb line in His hand.

8 And the Lord said to me, "Amos, what do you see?" And I said, "A plumb line." Then the Lord said: "Behold, I am setting a plumb line In the midst of My people Israel; I will not pass by them anymore.

9 The high places of Isaac shall be desolate, And the sanctuaries of Israel shall be laid waste. I will rise with the sword against the house of Jeroboam."

II. Key Summary

• The Lord God showed Amos locust swarms formed at the beginning of the late crop, after the king's mowings, eating up the grass of the land. Amos asked God to forgive, because "Jacob is small"; the Lord relented and said, "It shall not be" (vv. 1–3).

• The Lord God then showed him fire called for conflict, consuming the great deep and devouring the territory. Amos asked God to cease, for the same reason — "he is small"; the

Lord said, "This also shall not be" (vv. 4–6).

• The third vision was the Lord standing on a wall made with a plumb line, a plumb line in His hand. He said He would set the plumb line in the midst of "My people Israel" and would not pass by them anymore; the high places of Isaac and the sanctuaries of Israel would be laid waste, and He would rise with the sword against the house of Jeroboam (vv. 7–9).

III. Passage Analysis

"Oh, that Jacob may stand, for he is small!"

> At this vision of terrible judgment, the prophet's heart was moved with pity and compassion for Israel, and he asked God to consider Israel's frailty. [1]

Amos spoke twice, first asking God to "forgive," then to "cease," and both times he gave only one reason: Jacob was too small to stand (vv. 2, 5). Jacob had become this weak because his own sin had brought punishment on him; God heard the prophet's plea and had mercy on the people, and when the text says the Lord "relented," it means God graciously changed His course and did not carry the judgment out [2].

Amos asked twice, and twice the Lord said, "It shall not be."

"I am setting a plumb line in the midst of My people Israel"

> The northern kingdom is compared to a wall built by a plumb line. The "plumb line" stands for what God's people ought to follow — the standard their conduct is measured by; but when measured, they fell completely short of it. [2]

From this chapter through 9:10 there are five visions, each disaster heavier than the last; the first two were withdrawn because the prophet prayed, and the three starting with the plumb line would surely come [2]. This time God first asked, "What do you see?" Once Amos saw the plumb line, he no longer interceded; the word for "pass by" means to pass over, which is what God had done the first two times, and now He says, "not anymore" [2].

The wall was first built with a plumb line (v. 7), and now God measures it with the same line.

IV. Reflection Question

When you make a decision, what standard do you usually use to measure whether you're doing the right thing?

The plumb line God set in the midst of Israel is what God's people ought to follow [2]; when He measured with it, God said, "I will not pass by them anymore." (v. 8)

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Amos 7, https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/amos-7/

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), Chi Dao Study Bible notes, Chain-Reference Bible notes, Tong Yau-chi's Tien Dao Bible Commentary on Amos, Tsai Che-min's study notes (Amos chapter 7), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT07.htm